Grade 9 General

End-of-Term 1 Exam Booklet

Exam guide | Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Writing | Practice test + answers

Part 1 Vocabulary | **Part 2 Grammar** | **Part 3 Reading** | **Part 4 Writing**

1. Know your exam

Grade 9 General | Stage 5 | CEFR B1.1

Part	What you do	Questions	Marks
1 Vocabulary	Read a ~150-word text. Choose the right word for each gap (A, B or C).	5 gaps	10 (2 each)
2 Grammar	Read a ~150-word message. Choose the right grammar word for each gap.	5 gaps	10 (2 each)
3A Reading (at grade level)	Read a ~240-word text. Answer 8 multiple-choice questions.	8 questions: 4 specific info, 2 details, 1 inference, 1 overall meaning	24 (3 each)
3B Reading (beyond grade level)	Read a ~240-word text. Answer 8 multiple-choice questions.	8 questions: 4 details, 2 inference, 1 connections, 1 overall meaning	16 (2 each)
4 Writing	1.1 Read an email (~160 words) and write its main ideas in your own words: 2-3 sentences. 1.2 Write a reply of at least 130 words in paragraphs, answering 3 prompts.	2 tasks	40 (15 + 25)

Total: **Reading 60 marks** (10 + 10 + 24 + 16) and **Writing 40 marks**. Reading is on SwiftAssess; Writing is paper-based.

Themes that can appear

Chapter	Reading / Writing themes
Living Together, Learning Together	Success in college | An email from college (Writing) | Directions and places in a city
Shop Till You Drop!	Returns and refunds | Online shopping (Writing) | Selling, sharing and summarising

Top exam tips

- Read the **whole text first**, then choose each answer. Always read the words before and after a gap.
- In Parts 3A and 3B, underline key words in the question, then scan the text for them.
- Wrong options often look right. Check **every** word of your choice against the text.
- Part 4: never copy sentences from the email. Use your own words and write in paragraphs.
- Answer every question. Never leave a gap empty.

2. Part 1 - Vocabulary (24 target words)

Learn the meaning AND how the word is used in a sentence

Living Together, Learning Together

Word	Meaning
urban	in or about a city
residential	with homes, not shops or factories
commercial	with shops and offices
industrial	with factories
convenient	easy and close to use
comfortable	pleasant and relaxing
route	the way from one place to another
destination	the place you are going to
professor	a teacher at a college
tutor	a teacher who helps one student or a small group
facilities	buildings or equipment you can use (library, gym)
services	help that is provided (tech support)

Shop Till You Drop!

Word	Meaning
browse	look around without a plan
search	look for something specific
exchange	give back an item and take another
refund	money given back to you
receipt	paper that shows you paid
credit card	a card used to pay now and pay later
profit	money you make after costs
fee	money you pay for a service
brand	the name of a company or product
quality	how good something is
survey	questions asked to many people
prediction	saying what will happen

Extra Part 2 words (places and directions)

block | bus station | car park | directions | hotel | Internet | road | shopping mall | situation | strangers | street map | traffic lights | apartment | business area | central | neighborhood | peaceful | suburban | traffic | transportation

3. Part 2 - Grammar (7 points)

Learn the rule, see an example, avoid the trap

Grammar	Rule	Example	Exam trap
Verb forms G.19.2	enjoy / finish / avoid + **-ing** want / hope / plan / need + **to + verb** can / should / must + **base verb**	I enjoy **studying**. I want **to join** a club. I can **help**.	Not: enjoy to study
Future: going to G.15.2	am / is / are + going to + base verb (plans and predictions)	I am going to visit the library. It is going to rain.	Do not forget am / is / are
Coordinating conjunctions G.6.1	and = add | but = contrast | so = result | or = choice	The mall is big, **but** it is crowded.	Match the meaning; comma before but / so
Adverbial linkers G.2.5	First, Then, Also, However, Therefore, For example + comma	**However**, online prices are lower.	However = contrast, Therefore = result
Indirect questions G.17.4	Could you tell me + **where / when / if** + statement order	Could you tell me **where the bus station is**?	No is / do / does before the subject
Prepositions of place G.12.1	in, on, at, next to, opposite, near, between, in front of	The bank is **opposite** the hotel.	at = point, in = inside, on = surface
Dependent prepositions G.12.4	Some words need a fixed preposition	pay attention **to**, prepare **for**, good **at**, look forward **to**, afraid **of**	Learn them as one chunk

Modals for advice and rules (used in Lessons 7-8, 27-28, 35-36)

should = advice | **must / have to** = rule or necessity | **can** = ability or permission
Example: You **should** keep your receipt. You **must** bring the receipt to return an item.

Gap-fill method: 1) Read the whole sentence. 2) Decide what is missing: a verb form, a linker, a preposition? 3) Try each option in the gap. 4) Choose the one that is correct in **grammar AND meaning**.

4. Part 3 - Reading skills

3A = at grade level | 3B = beyond grade level

Question type	What it asks	How to answer
Specific information	A fact: a number, a name, a place, a time	Underline the key word in the question. **Scan** the text for it (numbers and capital letters help).
Details	Why / how / what happened?	Find the sentence in the text, then read the sentence before and after it.
Inference	The meaning of a word or what is not said directly	Look at the words around it. Is it positive or negative? Look at prefixes and suffixes (un-, re-, -ful).
Connections	Link the text to your life or the world	Ask: "Is this like something I know?" Choose the option that matches the idea in the text.
Overall meaning	The main idea or best title	**Skim**: read the first and last sentence of each paragraph. Choose the option that covers the whole text.

Four steps for every text

1 Skim the title and first lines (30 seconds).
2 Read the questions first and underline key words.
3 Scan the text and mark the answer sentence.
4 Check: why are the other two options wrong?

Trap watch

• An option uses words from the text but gives a **different meaning**.
• An option is **true** but does not answer **this** question.
• Words like **always, never, only** are often wrong.

Words to guess from context: if you do not know a word, ask: What kind of word is it (noun, verb, adjective)? Is the sentence about something good or bad? What would make sense here?

5. Part 4 - Writing (40 marks)

Task 1.1 summary (15 marks) + Task 1.2 reply email (25 marks)

Task 1.1 - Main ideas in your own words (2-3 sentences)

1) Read the email twice. 2) Underline 3 main points: who writes, what is happening, how they feel. 3) Write 2-3 sentences using **your own words**. Do not copy. Do not add your own opinion.
Frame: *[Name] writes about ... . He / She says that ... . He / She also feels ... because ... .*

Task 1.2 - Reply email (at least 130 words, 3 paragraphs)

Part	What to write	Useful language (FL.44)
Greeting	Hi / Dear + name	Hi Adam, | Dear Adam,
Opening	Thank them and answer the first question	Thanks for your email. | It was great to hear from you.
Paragraph 1	Answer prompt 1 with details and reasons	My school is ... because ... | My favourite place is ... as ...
Paragraph 2	Prompt 2: a past experience, in order, with feelings	On my first day, I felt ... because ... | First, ... Then, ... After that, ...
Paragraph 3	Prompt 3: advice or opinion with a reason	You should ... because ... | I think it is a good idea to ...
Closing	Finish politely	Write soon! | Best wishes, | Take care,

Checklist before you hand in

[ ] I answered all 3 prompts [ ] At least 130 words [ ] 3 clear paragraphs
[ ] Each paragraph has a topic sentence + a reason [ ] Past tense for past events
[ ] Linkers: first, then, also, however, because [ ] Capital letters, full stops, spelling checked

Model summary (Task 1.1 in the practice test): Adam has started college in Canada. He likes his classes and his roommate, but he gets lost on the big campus and feels nervous when he speaks English. He also misses his family and asks Sam about school life.

PRACTICE TEST - Part 1 Vocabulary

Read the text and choose A, B or C. (10 marks)

Last week my family moved to a new city. We chose a **(1)** ____ area, where there are only houses and apartments, so it is very quiet at night. It is also **(2)** ____ because the school, the supermarket and the bus stop are close to our home. My sister likes to **(3)** ____ online shops for cheap furniture, but my mother prefers to go to the mall. Yesterday she bought a lamp, but it was broken, so she asked the salesperson to **(4)** ____ it for a new one. She showed her **(5)** ____ to prove that she bought it there, and the problem was solved in five minutes.

1. **A** residential **B** industrial **C** commercial
2. **A** crowded **B** convenient **C** polluted
3. **A** browse **B** refund **C** exchange
4. **A** exchange **B** browse **C** predict
5. **A** fee **B** receipt **C** brand

PRACTICE TEST - Part 2 Grammar

Read the message and choose A, B or C. (10 marks)

Hi Noor,
I started college two weeks ago and I really enjoy **(1)** ____ new people. The campus is big, **(2)** ____ it is easy to find my way because of the street maps. Next month, I **(3)** ____ join the sports club. I also need to pay attention **(4)** ____ my lessons because the exams are difficult. Could you tell me **(5)** ____ you are free this weekend? Come and visit me!
Layla

1. **A** to meet **B** meeting **C** meet
2. **A** but **B** so **C** or
3. **A** am going to **B** going to **C** go
4. **A** to **B** for **C** at
5. **A** when **B** when are **C** what

PRACTICE TEST - Part 3A Reading

Read the text and choose A, B or C. (24 marks)

Returning Things to a Shop

Returning something to a shop can feel stressful, but it is easier if you know the rules. Most stores in the city allow customers to return an item within 14 days. You must bring the receipt, because it shows when and where you bought the product. Without a receipt, the shop may only give you store credit, not your money back.

Last Saturday, Omar bought a blue sweater at the mall for 120 dirhams. When he got home, he saw that it was the wrong size, so he went back the next day. The salesperson, Mr. Hamad, was very polite. He checked the receipt and asked, "Would you like to exchange it or get a refund?" Omar wanted a larger size, but the shop did not have one. Because of this, he chose a refund, and the money went back to his credit card in three days.

Some items cannot be returned at all. Shops often put a sign on the wall saying "No returns allowed" for underwear, headphones and sale items. It is a good idea to read these signs before you pay.

Omar learned an important lesson. Now he always keeps his receipts in a small box at home, and he tries on clothes before he buys them.

1. How many days can customers usually return an item?
A 7 **B** 14 **C** 30

2. How much did the sweater cost?
A 102 dirhams **B** 120 dirhams **C** 210 dirhams

3. What did Omar do the next day?
A He went back to the shop **B** He exchanged it online **C** He wore the sweater

4. How long did the refund take?
A One day **B** Three days **C** One week

5. Why did Omar choose a refund?
A He did not like blue **B** The shop did not have a larger size **C** The salesperson told him to

6. What may a shop give you if you have no receipt?
A Store credit **B** A free gift **C** A discount

7. In the text, "refund" means ...
A money that is returned to you **B** a new item **C** a paper that shows you paid

8. What is the best title for the text?
A How to Shop Online **B** Returning Items: Rules and an Example **C** Why Sweaters Are Expensive

PRACTICE TEST - Part 3B Reading (beyond grade level)

Read the text and choose A, B or C. (16 marks)

Succeeding in College

Starting college is exciting, but many new students find it hard to manage their time. Unlike school, no one tells you exactly what to do each day. Professors give assignments and expect students to prepare for classes on their own.

Successful students usually follow a routine. They attend every class, take notes and review them the same evening. Many also join study groups, where classmates explain difficult ideas to each other. This is more helpful than studying alone because you can ask questions immediately.

Another good habit is to visit the tutor early, not just before exams. Tutors can help you understand a topic, check your writing and suggest better study methods. However, a lot of students are too shy to ask for help, and they only go when their grades are already low.

Sleep and health matter too. Staying up all night to finish an assignment may seem sensible, but tired students cannot pay attention in class the next day. It is better to plan ahead and divide big tasks into small parts.

In short, college success does not depend only on intelligence. It depends on planning, asking for help and staying healthy.

1. What do professors expect students to do?
A Prepare for classes on their own **B** Find a tutor **C** Join study groups

2. What do successful students do in the evening?
A Review their notes **B** Visit the tutor **C** Finish assignments all night

3. Why are study groups helpful?
A They are quiet **B** Students can ask questions immediately **C** They are shorter than classes

4. Tutors can help students with ...
A paying fees **B** checking their writing **C** finding a dorm

5. In the text, "routine" means ...
A a regular way of doing things **B** a difficult exam **C** a free class

6. The writer thinks that staying up all night is ...
A a good idea **B** not a good idea **C** necessary

7. Students who visit tutors only when their grades are low are like people who ...
A see a doctor only when they are very ill **B** exercise every day **C** read before bed

8. What is the main idea of the text?
A Good habits and asking for help lead to college success **B** College is easier than school **C** Tutors are better than professors

PRACTICE TEST - Part 4 Writing (40 marks)

Hi Sam,
How are you? I am writing from my new college in Canada! I moved into the dorm three weeks ago. My roommate is friendly, but the room is small, so we keep our things in boxes.
The campus is huge. There is a library next to the cafeteria, and a health center near the main gate. I get lost every morning because I cannot find the right building!
My classes are interesting, but I feel nervous when I speak English with the professors. I study with a tutor twice a week, and she helps me a lot.
I miss my family and our food. Last weekend, I cooked a traditional dish for my classmates, and they loved it.
What about you? How is your school life? What is your favourite place?
Write soon!
Adam

1.1 Read the email. Write the main ideas of the email in your own words. Write 2-3 sentences. *(15 marks)*

1.2 Read the email again. Now write a reply to Adam in which you: *(25 marks)*
• describe your school and your favourite place there
• tell about your first day at school and how you felt
• give Adam advice about feeling nervous
Write at least 130 words in paragraphs.

Answer key

Check your work and count your marks

Part	Answers	Marks
1 Vocabulary	1 A residential | 2 B convenient | 3 A browse | 4 A exchange | 5 B receipt	/10
2 Grammar	1 B meeting | 2 A but | 3 A am going to | 4 A to | 5 A when	/10
3A Reading	1 B | 2 B | 3 A | 4 B | 5 B | 6 A | 7 A | 8 B	/24 (3 each)
3B Reading	1 A | 2 A | 3 B | 4 B | 5 A | 6 B | 7 A | 8 A	/16 (2 each)
4 Writing	1.1: compare with the model summary on the Writing page. 1.2: use the checklist and ask your teacher to mark it.	/40

My score

Reading (60)	Writing (40)	Total (100)

Next steps: weak in Part 1? Re-learn the word list. Weak in Part 2? Revise the grammar table. Weak in Part 3? Practise skim and scan. Weak in Part 4? Rewrite your reply using the checklist.